OSHA Confined Space Rescue Checklist (29 CFR 1926.1211)

Use before each construction permit space entry to confirm rescue arrangements and retrieval equipment are in place.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.1211

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item is marked Defect, do not allow entry until it is corrected, and record what was done.
3. Manufacturer's instructions and site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.1211: Rescue and emergency services (Part 1926 Subpart AA, Confined Spaces in Construction) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-1211-rescue-emergency-services

SECTION A | Rescue service selection, briefing and SDS

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Response time evaluated Ref. 1926.1211(a)(1)	Employer can show the prospective rescuer's ability to respond to a summons in a timely manner was assessed against the identified hazards	☐	☐	☐	
2	Rescue proficiency evaluated Ref. 1926.1211(a)(2)	Employer can show the service's proficiency with rescue tasks and equipment was assessed for this permit space or type of space	☐	☐	☐	
3	Reach time Ref. 1926.1211(a)(3)(i)	Selected team can reach victims within a time frame appropriate for the hazards identified	☐	☐	☐	
4	Team equipment and skills Ref. 1926.1211(a)(3)(ii)	Selected team is equipped for and proficient in the rescue services needed	☐	☐	☐	
5	Unavailability notice Ref. 1926.1211(a)(3)(iii)	Selected team has agreed to tell the employer immediately if it becomes unavailable	☐	☐	☐	
6	Hazard briefing Ref. 1926.1211(a)(4)	Each rescue team or service has been told the hazards it may face when called to this site	☐	☐	☐	
7	Access to permit spaces Ref. 1926.1211(a)(5)	Selected team has had access to every permit space from which rescue may be needed, to plan and practice	☐	☐	☐	
8	SDS for treating facility Ref. 1926.1211(d)	SDS or similar written information for substances kept at the worksite can be made available to the medical facility treating an exposed entrant	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Employee rescuers: PPE, training and practice

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
9	No cost to employees Ref. 1926.1211(b)	Designated rescuers have received all equipment and training without paying for it	☐	☐	☐	
10	Rescue PPE issued Ref. 1926.1211(b)(1)	Each designated rescuer has the PPE needed to conduct permit space rescues safely	☐	☐	☐	
11	PPE proficiency Ref. 1926.1211(b)(1)	Each designated rescuer has been trained and is proficient in using that PPE	☐	☐	☐	
12	Rescue duty training Ref. 1926.1211(b)(2)	Each designated rescuer has been trained in their assigned rescue duties	☐	☐	☐	
13	Authorized entrant proficiency Ref. 1926.1211(b)(2)	Each designated rescuer has completed training and established proficiency as an authorized entrant under 1926.1207 and 1926.1208	☐	☐	☐	
14	First aid and CPR training Ref. 1926.1211(b)(3)	Each designated rescuer has been trained in basic first aid and CPR	☐	☐	☐	
15	Certified member available Ref. 1926.1211(b)(3)	At least one team member with current basic first aid and CPR certification is available during the entry	☐	☐	☐	
16	Practice rescue current Ref. 1926.1211(b)(4)	Rescuers have done a simulated rescue within the past 12 months, or properly performed a real rescue in that period in the same or a similar permit space	☐	☐	☐	
17	Practice space realistic Ref. 1926.1211(b)(4)	Practice used the actual space or one simulating its opening size, configuration and accessibility, removing a dummy, manikin or person	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Non-entry rescue and retrieval systems

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
18	Rescue method decided Ref. 1926.1211(c)	Non-entry rescue is used, or there is a stated reason that retrieval equipment would increase overall entry risk or not contribute to rescue	☐	☐	☐	
19	Entry rescue service designated Ref. 1926.1211(c)	An entry rescue service is designated where non-entry rescue was not selected	☐	☐	☐	
20	Retrieval system in use Ref. 1926.1211(c)	Where non-entry rescue is selected, a retrieval system or method is used each time an authorized entrant enters	☐	☐	☐	
21	Backup assistance confirmed Ref. 1926.1211(c)	Before entry, the entry employer has confirmed emergency assistance would be available if non-entry rescue fails	☐	☐	☐	
22	Harness worn Ref. 1926.1211(c)(1)	Each authorized entrant wears a chest or full body harness	☐	☐	☐	
23	Line attachment point Ref. 1926.1211(c)(1)	Retrieval line is attached at the center of the back near shoulder level, above the head, or at another point shown to give a profile small enough for removal	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION C | Non-entry rescue and retrieval systems

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
24	Wristlets or anklets justified Ref. 1926.1211(c)(1)	If wristlets or anklets are used, employer can demonstrate a harness is infeasible or more hazardous and wristlets or anklets are the safest, most effective option	☐	☐	☐	
25	Line anchored outside Ref. 1926.1211(c)(2)	Other end of the retrieval line is attached to a mechanical device or fixed point outside the space so rescue can start immediately	☐	☐	☐	
26	Mechanical device for deep vertical spaces Ref. 1926.1211(c)(2)	A mechanical retrieval device is available at vertical type permit spaces more than 5 feet (1.52 meters) deep	☐	☐	☐	
27	Unsuitable equipment excluded Ref. 1926.1211(c)(3)	No retrieval lines likely to tangle with other entrants' lines and none that will not work in the space's internal configuration	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME